



Australia Awards

Referee Report

The applicant has named you as a referee in support of an application for an Australia Awards Scholarship supported by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT) for study in Australia. To assist in the selection process, we would like to receive your views on the applicant's suitability for a Scholarship, in particular on their capabilities and personal qualities, academic competence (including, where applicable, their research ability) and potential outcomes.

1. Personal Details

Personal details	Applicant response
Applicant's details	Applicant Answers
Full name (as it appears in passport)	Antonio Lestimasi Moeaki
Email	al.moeaki@gmail.com
Area of research interest	Economics / Statistics
Referee's details	Referee Answers
Family name	Faupula
Given names	Semisi Lulu
Mobile no.	+676 77-17553
Work no.	+676 7400752
Email	sfaupula@finance.gov.to
Employing organisation	Ministry of Finance
Name	Semisi Lulu Faupula
Town/City, Country	Nuku'alofa/ Tonga
Position title	Chief Economist
Starting date	3 / 6 / 2015
Length of time you have known applicant	☐ Less than 3 months ☐ 3-12 months ☒ 1-2 years ☐ 2-5 years



Personal details	Applicant response
	☐ More than 5 years
Relationship to applicant (e.g. direct supervisor, lecturer, peer, etc)	I am Mr. Antonio Lestimasi Moeaki direct supervisor at the Ministry of Finance. I oversee his work in economic and fiscal policy analysis. He reports to me on matters related to monitoring the Government's fiscal position. I have worked closely with him and can attest to his strong performance and professionalism.
Authorised official stamp of the organisation.	

2. Evaluation of applicant's capabilities and behaviours

Please evaluate the applicant against the following criteria*

Criteria	Very good	Satisfactory	Needs coaching	Not observed
Shapes strategic thinking (meaning that they: inspire a sense of purpose and direction; focus strategically; harness information and opportunities; and show judgement, intelligence and commonsense)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Achieves results (meaning that they: build organisation capability and responsiveness; marshal professional expertise; steer and implement change and deal with uncertainty; ensure closure and deliver on intended results)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Cultivates productive working relationships (meaning that they: nurture internal and external relationships; facilitate cooperation and partnerships; value individual differences and diversity; and guide, mentor and develop people)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Displays personal drive and integrity (meaning that they: demonstrate professionalism and probity; commit to action; display resilience; promote and adopt a positive and balanced approach to work; and demonstrate self-awareness and a commitment to personal development)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Communicates and negotiates effectively (meaning that they: communicate clearly; listen, understand and adapts to audience; and negotiates persuasively)	☒	☐	☐	☐



3. General Comments

Why should the applicant be considered for a Scholarship?

Mr. Antonio Lestimasi Moeaki should be considered for a scholarship due to his strong academic ability, proven research potential, and commitment to policy-relevant work. His background demonstrates strong analytical skills, discipline, and a clear focus on areas of national importance. He plays a key role at the Ministry of Finance, contributing to economic and fiscal policy analysis and monitoring the Government's fiscal position.

4. Academic Referee comments – applicable to PhD candidates only (Not applicable)

In the past five years, how many research higher degree (PhD, Masters) candidates have you worked with?

Please insert text response here

Your professional knowledge of the applicant is:
(please select which box is most relevant)

- ☐ Very detailed
☐ Very good
☐ Good
☐ Incomplete

Score the following out of 10

A score of 10 means that you regard the applicant as being in the top 2% of all candidates in each assessment category.

- 9 - top 5%
8 - top 10%
7 - top 20%
6 - top 30%
5 - top 40%
4 - upper 50%
3 - upper 60%
2 - upper 70%
1 - bottom 30%

Criteria	Score
(a) Research potential: intrinsic research potential (as distinct from examination results).	
(b) Creative Ability: ability to develop original ideas/hypotheses, to write original compositions or to assemble conventional work in some original way	
(c) Initiative: ability to embark on new ideas or approaches without prompting	



Criteria	Score
(d) Perseverance: ability to work steadily even in difficult circumstances or where motivation or external direction is minimal.	
(e) Critical thinking: ability to differentiate between sound and irrationally based thinking	
(f) Team work: ability to work in a research group	
(g) Ability to Communicate: both written and spoken	

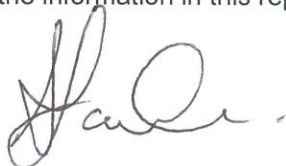
5. Academic Referee comments – applicable to PhD candidates only (Not applicable)

Please comment on **evidence** of the applicant's research potential and achievement (such as the outcomes of their research experience and training, including university studies, publications, papers, and other relevant work) and any other comments relevant to the applicant's admission to a PhD (maximum 300 words).

6. Referees Declaration and Signature

I declare that the information in this report is true and correct.

Signature:



Date 24/ 4 / 2026

Thank you for assisting the Australian Government in identifying an outstanding candidate for an Australia Awards Scholarship.

